

One-Point Perspective

The single vanishing point

One-point perspective is the simplest perspective system. One vanishing point on the horizon line handles all depth recession. It works best for scenes viewed head-on: corridors, roads, room interiors, railways.

KEY CONCEPTS

The Setup

Draw a horizon line (eye level). Mark one vanishing point (VP) on it. All lines receding into depth converge to this single point. Lines parallel to the picture plane (horizontal and vertical) do NOT converge.

Drawing a Box in 1PP

1) Draw a square (the face closest to you). 2) Draw lines from each corner to the VP. 3) Draw a rectangle connecting four of these lines at the desired depth. 4) Erase the construction lines that go past the box.

Eye Level & Horizon

The horizon line IS your eye level. Objects above the horizon line are seen from below (you see their bottom). Objects below it are seen from above (you see their top). Objects at eye level show neither top nor bottom.

Applications

Interiors, cityscapes, still lifes with strong front-facing geometry. Most beginners overuse 1PP because it's simple — in practice, 2PP is more common and more dynamic. Learn 1PP as the foundation.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Draw a hallway or corridor in 1-point perspective from scratch.
2. Draw 5 boxes in 1PP — above horizon, below, and overlapping the horizon line.
3. Find a photo of a room interior and draw the 1PP construction lines over it.

FURTHER READING

■ CTRL+Paint – Linear Perspective

<https://www.ctrlpaint.com/videos/linear-perspective>

■ Draw a Box – Perspective

<https://drawabox.com/lesson/1/6>